

DAL at HOU · Sunday 2026-10-04 13:00 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: DAL +3.0 / HOU -3.0, total 48.5. Trip: DAL → HOU 225 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DAL 7 days, HOU 7 days. Roof: nan.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	DAL	A at NYG	20–28	–3.0	miss	244	69	+10.4	+15.7	+23.9	0.48	1
2	DAL	H vs WAS	37–20	–3.5	cover	345	66	+15.1	+12.7	+2.2	0.56	0
3	DAL	N vs BAL	31–34	+3.0	push	424	148	+13.3	+8.6	+12.6	0.47	1
1	HOU	H vs BUF	31–36	+1.5	miss	398	124	+1.5	+5.6	+15.6	0.48	2
2	HOU	H vs CIN	6–20	–3.0	miss	413	60	–9.7	–18.9	–6.3	0.34	0
3	HOU	A at IND	17–19	–1.5	miss	237	70	–3.1	–4.5	–8.1	0.43	0

Last game EPA (PBP): DAL off +8.6, def allowed +12.6, net -3.9, SR 0.47. HOU off -4.5, def allowed -8.1, net +3.6, SR 0.43. Records: DAL 1–2, HOU 0–3. ATS: DAL 1–1, HOU 0–3.

2. Lookahead and rest

- DAL: last played week 3 (Sunday late window, neutral site, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: home vs TB, non-division, Thursday night.
- HOU: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 2). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs TEN, division, Sunday early window.

3. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤ 10 last: no
- short week: no
- trip ≥ 1000 mi: no
- TO ≥ 3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

4. Stack, without double-counting

Header per chair is the walk-forward record: traits picked by max parent-minus-child gap on seasons before N at $n \geq 10$, printed on season N, N = 2019–2025, pooled. Every printed game is out of sample. The full-window stack (picked on all seasons at $n \geq 20$) and its diagnostics sit in the block below it. Same gate on every slot.

Chairs are built on different conditioning sets — read the second as a cross-check on the first, not a second sample.

- HOU -3.0** — one population: Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3; off a 1-score loss; off a road game. Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): equal rest, off a loss, off an ATS miss, off a loss as favorite, off a division game, scored ≤ 17 last, scored ≤ 21 last, allowed ≤ 21 last....
- Walk-forward 4–8 (33.3%, n=12)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:1-1 20:1-1 21:0-3 22:2-2 23:0-0 24:0-0 25:0-1. OOS cover margin median -5.8, $P(>+7)$ 0.08, $P(<-7)$ 0.42. Traits picked in ≥ 4 of 7 folds: Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3 (7/7), off a 1-score loss (6/7), equal rest (4/7), next game is road (4/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3; off a 1-score loss; off a road game. ATS 6–13–1 (31.6%, n=20).
- By season: 15:0-1 16:1-1 17:0-2 18:1-0 19:0-1 20:1-1 21:0-3 22:1-2 23:0-1 24:1-0 25:1-1
- Cover margin: median -4.5, q25/q75 -10.2/+4.0; $P(>+7)$ 0.15, $P(<-7)$ 0.40
- Parent minus child: without 'off a 1-score loss': 30–39–5 (43.5%, n=74), the games it removed: 24–26–4 (48.0%, n=54) | without 'off a road game': 7–18–1 (28.0%, n=26), the games it removed: 1–5 (16.7%, n=6)

- Anchor alone 44–57–6 (43.6%, n=107); anchor minus stack 38–44–5 (46.3%, n=87)
- Stack by line bucket: -1 to -3 6–13–1 (31.6%, n=20)
- Contrary cross: equal rest: 20–36–3 (35.7%, n=59) → in stack 3–9 (25.0%, n=12) | off a loss: 17–31–2 (35.4%, n=50) → in stack 6–13–1 (31.6%, n=20) | both off a loss: 9–19–1 (32.1%, n=29) → in stack 3–10–1 (23.1%, n=14) | off an ATS miss: 17–28–3 (37.8%, n=48) → in stack 3–8–1 (27.3%, n=12)
- **DAL +3.0** — one population: Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3; trip 200–1000 mi; opponent off an ATS miss; opponent off a loss. Not added (no gap with n ≥ 20 left): equal rest, 0 time zones, off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off a loss as dog, off a neutral-site game, scored 27–33 last, scored ≥30 last...
- **Walk-forward 7–6 (53.8%, n=13)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:2-2 20:2-0 21:1-1 22:1-0 23:0-1 24:0-1 25:1-1. OOS cover margin median +2.0, P(>+7) 0.31, P(<-7) 0.15. Traits picked in ≥4 of 7 folds: Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3 (7/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3; trip 200–1000 mi; opponent off an ATS miss; opponent off a loss. ATS 20–5–1 (80.0%, n=26).
- By season: 15:4-0 16:2-0 18:2-1 19:1-0 20:1-0 21:2-1 22:3-1 23:4-0 24:1-0 25:0-2
- Cover margin: median +5.5, q25/q75 +0.5/+9.4; P(>+7) 0.35, P(<-7) 0.04
- Parent minus child: without 'trip 200–1000 mi': 24–13–2 (64.9%, n=39), the games it removed: 4–8–1 (33.3%, n=13) | without 'opponent off an ATS miss': 23–8–1 (74.2%, n=32), the games it removed: 3–3 (50.0%, n=6) | without 'opponent off a loss': 23–6–2 (79.3%, n=31), the games it removed: 3–1–1 (75.0%, n=5)
- Anchor alone 57–44–6 (56.4%, n=107); anchor minus stack 37–39–5 (48.7%, n=81)
- Stack by line bucket: +1 to +3 20–5–1 (80.0%, n=26)
- Contrary cross: allowed ≥30 last: 12–14–1 (46.2%, n=27) → in stack 3–1 (75.0%, n=4)
- **Total 48.5** — tightest full-window cut clearing n = 20: Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45–49 — O–U 44–32 (57.9%, n=76).
- By season (O–U): 15:2-2 16:9-3 17:3-3 18:7-5 19:6-2 20:0-3 21:6-4 22:3-6 23:1-1 24:3-2 25:4-1
- Total margin (points – line): median +2.8, q25/q75 -8.0/+10.1; P(>+7) 0.34, P(<-7) 0.26
- **Walk-forward 31–40 in the training cut's direction (43.7%, n=72; raw O–U 36–35–1)** — cut chosen on seasons before N, printed on N; O/U after each year is the direction the training cut pointed. By year: 19:6-20 20:0-30 21:6-40 22:8-8-10 23:3-50 24:4-90 25:9-4U. OOS total margin median +0.8. Cuts picked: Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45–49 (3/7), line within 3, total 45–49 (3/7), line within 3, total ≥47 (1/7).
- By total band: 45–49 44–32 (n=76)

Appendix A. Sides — HOU –3.0

HOU (home favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home favorite	265–294–16	47.4%	575
Sunday early window home favorite	145–150–10	49.2%	305
home fav –1 to –3	85–100–9	45.9%	194
Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	102–106–10	49.0%	218
Sunday early window home fav –1 to –3	44–57–6	43.6%	107

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window home fav –1 to –3	7–18–1	28.0%	26
equal rest, Sunday early window home fav –1 to –3	20–36–3	35.7%	59
equal rest, home fav –1 to –3	43–65–5	39.8%	113
off a loss, Sunday early window home fav –1 to –3	17–31–2	35.4%	50
off an ATS miss, home favorite	112–144–8	43.8%	264
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window home favorite	53–75–5	41.4%	133
off a 1-score loss, home favorite	61–84–3	42.1%	148
off a loss, home favorite	111–141–6	44.0%	258
both off a loss, Sunday early window home fav –1 to –3	9–19–1	32.1%	29
rush yards ≤75 last, Sunday early window home favorite	21–35	37.5%	56
off yards ≤250 last, Sunday early window home favorite	6–14–1	30.0%	21
off a 1-score loss, home fav –1 to –3	21–34–2	38.2%	57

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a loss, home fav -1 to -3	40-57-5	41.2%	102
rush yards ≤75 last, home favorite	47-65-4	42.0%	116
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window home favorite	27-41-2	39.7%	70
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3	17-28-3	37.8%	48
off a loss, Sunday early window home favorite	55-73-3	43.0%	131
off an ATS miss, home fav -1 to -3	38-52-6	42.2%	96
equal rest, home favorite	154-180-10	46.1%	344
next game is road, home favorite	179-206-8	46.5%	393
next game is division, Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3	11-18	37.9%	29
off yards ≤250 last, Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3	3-7-1	30.0%	11
lost last despite net EPA ≥ +1, home fav -1 to -3	7-3	70.0%	10
off EPA ≤ -1 last, Sunday early window home favorite	48-60-3	44.4%	111
next game is road, home fav -1 to -3	57-70-4	44.9%	131
opponent off a loss, home favorite	142-162-7	46.7%	311
opponent off a loss, Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3	21-29-2	42.0%	52
off a road game, Sunday early window home fav -1 to -3	30-39-5	43.5%	74

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): equal rest, home favorite, next game is road, home favorite, opponent off a loss, home favorite. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

Appendix B. Sides — DAL +3.0

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

DAL (road dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road dog	294-265-16	52.6%	575
Sunday early window road dog	150-145-10	50.8%	305
road dog +1 to +3	100-85-9	54.1%	194
Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	106-102-10	51.0%	218
Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	57-44-6	56.4%	107

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog +1 to +3	40-19	67.8%	59
off EPA ≥ +8 last, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	25-10	71.4%	35
trip 200-1000 mi, road dog	179-135-6	57.0%	320
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog +1 to +3	33-16	67.3%	49
trip 200-1000 mi, Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	41-22-2	65.1%	65
TO ≤1 last, road dog +1 to +3	75-49-5	60.5%	129
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, Sunday early window road dog	38-21-2	64.4%	61
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog	61-39-2	61.0%	102
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	21-9	70.0%	30
next game is prime time, road dog	58-37-2	61.1%	97
equal rest, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	36-20-3	64.3%	59
trip 200-1000 mi, road dog +1 to +3	64-42-3	60.4%	109
scored ≥30 last, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	22-10-2	68.8%	34
equal rest, road dog +1 to +3	65-43-5	60.2%	113
opponent off a loss, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	31-17-2	64.6%	50
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog	77-54-1	58.8%	132

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
opponent off an ATS miss, road dog	144–112–8	56.2%	264
TO ≤1 last, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	40–24–3	62.5%	67
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window road dog	75–53–5	58.6%	133
scored ≥30 last, road dog +1 to +3	34–20–2	63.0%	56
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window road dog	107–81–3	56.9%	191
opponent off a loss, road dog	141–111–6	56.0%	258
both off a loss, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	19–9–1	67.9%	29
next game is prime time, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	13–5	72.2%	18
next game is prime time, road dog +1 to +3	24–13	64.9%	37
opponent off a loss, road dog +1 to +3	57–40–5	58.8%	102
next game is prime time, Sunday early window road dog	32–20–1	61.5%	53
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window road dog +1 to +3	28–17–3	62.2%	48

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): trip 200–1000 mi, road dog. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

Appendix C. Total 48.5 — n ≥ 10 cuts

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45–49	44–32	57.9%	76
line within 3, total 45–49	75–61–1	55.1%	137
Sunday early window, total 45–49	106–90–1	54.1%	197
Sunday early window, total ≥47	93–81–3	53.4%	177
Sunday early window	267–249–5	51.7%	521
line within 3, total ≥47	63–71–3	47.0%	137
total ≥47	167–179–5	48.3%	351
total 45–49	187–175–2	51.7%	364
line within 3	185–194–5	48.8%	384
Sunday early window, line within 3	107–110–2	49.3%	219
Sunday early window, line within 3, total ≥47	37–37–1	50.0%	75

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).